

2.1.4: Evidence Collection

Mission: Determine who invented the computer.

Directions: Use this notecatcher to document your findings as you go. For easy access, open this activity in a new tab!

Solution Code

Charles Babbage

1. Time Period: Early 1800s

2. What did the term 'computer' mean? Babbage used terms like "machine" a
He thought of computers as machines that could calculate complex math wit

3. Main contribution: Babbage desgined the world's first automatic comput
The Ananalytical Engine is potentially the world's first programmable comp
although it was never actually made.

Ada Lovelace

1. Time Period: 1840s, same time as Babbage

2. What did the term 'computer' mean? Lovelace thought of a computer as a
machine that could do complex math - she believed that Babbage's Analytic
could also be programmed to complete tasks outside of just math.

3. Main contribution: Lovelace wrote the first computer program/algorithm
Babbage's Analytical Engine

Alan Turing:

1. Time Period: 1912 - 1954

2. What did the term 'computer' mean? A computer was a machine that could
things in memory and be programmed by using algorithms

3. Main contribution: invented modern computing, wrote the paper that bec

foundation of computer science

Mauchly and Eckert

1. Time Period: 1940s
2. What did the term 'computer' mean? A machine that could calculate comp
3. Main contribution: created the first electronic computer

ENIAC Programmers

1. Time Period: 1940s
2. What did the term 'computer' mean? A machine that could calculate comp
mathematical equations
3. Main contribution: first programmers - programmed the ENIAC

Grace Hopper

1. Time Period: 1960s
2. What did the term 'computer' mean? A digital machine that you could pr
although writing a program was very difficult
3. Main contribution: developed the first compiler and the COBOL programm
language - made writing programs much easier

Mark Dean

1. Time Period: 1970s - current
2. What did the term 'computer' mean? A device that could be programmed a
by all people

3. Main contribution: ISA systems bus that enabled peripherals to be connected to computers; color PC monitor, first gigahertz processing chip

Bonus Exhibit

1. Who is missing from this picture? Mark Dean (black) and all of the women missing.

2. What questions do you have about this image? Who chooses what people are included? Why were these people chosen over others?

3. Why do you think some are included while others are not? Women and people of color have traditionally been left out of the history books while white men are to be front and center. This has to do with historical context - women and people of color were not given as many opportunities or viewed as equals at the time.

Starter Code

Charles Babbage

1. Time Period:

2. What did the term 'computer' mean?

3. Main contribution:

Ada Lovelace

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2. What did the term 'computer' mean?

3. Main contribution:

Alan Turing:

1. Time Period:

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Grace Hopper

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Mark Dean

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2. What did the term 'computer' mean?

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